K. J. Kevin Feng

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Education

2021 – 2026 **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Ph.D. Human Centered Design & Engineering
Dissertation: *Designing for Interactive Systems Powered by Generally Capable AI*
Advisors: David W. McDonald (HCDE), Amy X. Zhang (CSE)

2021 – 2023 M.S. Human Centered Design & Engineering

2017 – 2021 **Princeton University**, Princeton, NJ
B.S.E. Computer Science, Magna cum laude
Thesis: *Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale*
Advisor: Arvind Narayanan
Minors: technology & society, visual arts

01 – 05 2020 **National University of Singapore**, Singapore
Study Abroad, Computer Science

Publications

* denotes equal contribution. Acceptance rates for venues, when available, are in [square brackets].

Refereed Conference and Journal Papers

[c.17] Lujain Ibrahim, Katherine M. Collins, Sunnie S.Y. Kim, Anka Reuel, Max Lamparth, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Lama Ahmad, Prajna Soni, Alia El Kattan, Merlin Stein, Siddharth Swaroop, Ilia Sucholutsky, Andrew Strait, Q. Vera Liao, Umang Bhatt. Measuring and Mitigating Overreliance is Necessary for Building Human-Compatible AI. *AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES '26)*. Malmö, Sweden. October 2026. [22%].

[c.16] Rock Yuren Pang, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Shangbin Feng, Chu Li, Weijia Shi, Yulia Tsvetkov, Jeffrey Heer, Katharina Reinecke. Interactive Reasoning: Visualizing and Controlling Chain-of-Thought Reasoning in Large Language Models. *ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '26)*. Limassol, Cyprus. July 2026. [27.5%].

[c.15] Leon Staufer, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Kevin Wei, Luke Bailey, Yawen Duan, Mick Yang, A. Pinar Ozisik, Stephen Casper, Noam Kolt. The 2025 AI Agent Index: Documenting Technical and Safety Features of Deployed Agentic AI Systems. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '26)*. Montréal, Canada. June 2026. [33.0%].

[c.14] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Kevin Pu, Matt Latzke, Tal August, Pao Siangliulue, Jonathan Bragg, Daniel S. Weld, Amy X. Zhang, Joseph Chee Chang. Cocoa: Co-Planning and Co-Execution with AI Agents. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*. Barcelona, Spain. April 2026. [25.3%]. Best Paper (top 1% of submissions).

[c.13] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tzu-Sheng Kuo, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Inyoung Cheong, Kenneth Holstein, Amy X. Zhang. PolicyPad: Collaborative Prototyping of LLM Policies. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*. Barcelona, Spain. April 2026. [25.3%].

[c.12] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tzu-Sheng Kuo, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Inyoung Cheong, Kenneth Holstein, Amy X. Zhang. Expert-Driven Prototyping of LLM Behavioral Policies: Case Studies in Mental Health and Law. *2nd Conference by the International Association for Safe & Ethical AI (IASEAI '26)*. Paris, France. February 2026.

[c.11] Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Chan Young Park, Amy X. Zhang. SPICA: Retrieving Scenarios for Pluralistic In-Context Alignment. *Findings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL '25)*. Vienna, Austria. July 2025.

[c.10] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Q. Vera Liao, Ziang Xiao, Jennifer Wortman Vaughan, Amy X. Zhang, David W. McDonald. Canvil: Designerly Adaptation for LLM-Powered User Experiences. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025. [24.9%].

[c.9] Kevin Pu, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tovi Grossman, Tom Hope, Bhavana Dalvi Mishra, Matt Latzke, Jonathan Bragg, Joseph Chee Chang, Pao Siangliulue. IdeaSynth: Iterative Research Idea Development Through Evolving and Composing Idea Facets with Literature-Grounded Feedback. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025. [24.9%].

[c.8] Inyoung Cheong, King Xia, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Amy X. Zhang. (A)I Am Not a Lawyer, But...: Engaging Legal Experts towards Responsible LLM Policies for Legal Advice. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '24)*. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. June 2024. [22.9%].

[c.7] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Xander Koo, Lawrence Tan, Amy S. Bruckman*, David W. McDonald*, Amy X. Zhang*. Mapping the Design Space of Teachable Social Media Feed Experiences. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24)*. Honolulu, HI. May 2024. [26.3%].

[c.6] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Nick Ritchie, Pia Blumenthal, Andy Parsons, Amy X. Zhang. Examining the Impact of Provenance-Enabled Media on Trust and Accuracy Perceptions. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW '23)*. Minneapolis, MN. October 2023. [32.7%].

[c.5] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Maxwell James Coppock, David W. McDonald. How Do UX Practitioners Communicate AI as a Design Material? Artifacts, Conceptions, and Propositions. *ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '23)*. Pittsburgh, PA. July 2023. [24.0%].

[c.4] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tony W. Li, Amy X. Zhang. Understanding Collaborative Practices and Tools of Professional UX Practitioners in Software Organizations. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23)*. Hamburg, Germany. April 2023. [28.4%].

[c.3] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald. Addressing UX Practitioners' Challenges in Designing ML Applications: an Interactive Machine Learning Approach. *ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '23)*. Sydney, Australia. March 2023. [24.1%].

[c.2] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Kevin Song, Kejing Li, Oishee Chakrabarti, Marshini Chetty. Investigating How University Students in the United States Encounter and Deal With Misinformation in Private WhatsApp Chats During COVID-19. *Eighteenth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS '22)*. Boston, MA. August 2022. [27.8%].

[c.1] Ruoxi Shang, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Chirag Shah. Why Am I Not Seeing It? Understanding Lay Users' Needs in Counterfactual Explanations for Everyday Recommendations. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '22)*. Seoul, South Korea. June 2022. [25.2%].

Preprints

[p.1] Micah Carroll, Adeline Foote, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Marcus Williams, Anca Dragan, W. Bradley Knox*, Smitha Milli*. CTRL-Rec: Controlling Recommender Systems With Natural Language. https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.12742.

Lightly Refereed Papers and Posters

[l.9] Tanjal Shukla, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Leijie Wang, Mohammad Rostami, Amy X. Zhang. Hedwig: Dynamic Autonomy for Coding Agents Under Local Oversight. *ACM Conference on AI and Agentic Systems (CAIS '26)* (Industry Spotlight Award). San Jose, CA. May 2026.

[l.8] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Tae Soo Kim, Rock Yuren Pang, Faria Huq, Tal August, Amy X. Zhang. On the Regulatory Potential of User Interfaces for AI Agent Governance. *Regulatable ML workshop @ NeurIPS '25* (Oral). San Diego, CA. December 2025.

[l.7] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Inyoung Cheong, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Amy X. Zhang. Policy Prototyping for LLMs: Pluralistic Alignment via Interactive and Collaborative Policymaking. *Bidirectional Human-AI Alignment workshop @ ICLR '25* (Oral). Singapore. April 2025.

[l.6] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald, Amy X. Zhang. Levels of Autonomy for AI Agents. *Knight First Amendment Institute symposium: AI and Democratic Freedoms*. New York City, NY. April 2025.

[l.5] Andrew Konya, Aviv Ovadya, **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Lisa Schirch, Colin Irwin, Amy X. Zhang. Chain of Alignment: Integrating Public Will with Expert Intelligence for Language

Model Alignment. *Pluralistic Alignment workshop @ NeurIPS '24*. Vancouver, Canada. December 2024.

[l.4] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Inyoung Cheong, King Xia, Amy X. Zhang. Case Repositories: Towards Case-Based Reasoning for AI Alignment. *AI Meets Moral Philosophy and Moral Psychology (MP2) workshop @ NeurIPS '23*. New Orleans, LA. December 2023.

[l.3] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, David W. McDonald, Amy X. Zhang. Teachable Agents for End-User Empowerment in Personalized Feed Curation. *Knight First Amendment Institute symposium: Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society*. New York City, NY. April 2023. [18.9%].

[l.2] **K. J. Kevin Feng***, Alice Gao*, Johanna S. Karras*. Towards Semantically Aware Word Cloud Shape Generation. *Adjunct Proceedings of the ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '22)*. Bend, OR. October 2022.

[l.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng**, Amy X. Zhang. From Handoffs to Co-Creation: Deepening Collaboration between Designers, Developers, and Data Science Workers in UX Design. *InContext Workshop @ CHI '22)*. New Orleans, LA. May 2022.

Workshops organized

[w.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng***, Rock Yuren Pang*, Tzu-Sheng Kuo, Amy A. Winecoff, Emily Tseng, David Gray Widder, Harini Suresh, Katharina Reinecke, Amy X. Zhang. Sociotechnical AI Governance: Challenges and Opportunities for *Workshop at the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. Yokohama, Japan. April 2025.

Theses

[t.2] **K. J. Kevin Feng**. Designing for Interactive Systems Powered By Generally Capable AI. *University of Washington Department of Human Centered Design & Engineering*. Seattle, WA. August 2026.

[t.1] **K. J. Kevin Feng**. Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale. *Princeton University Department of Computer Science*. Princeton, NJ. April 2021.

Positions Held

09 2026 – Senior Applied Scientist, **Microsoft**, Mountain View, CA
Evaluation science and helping launch Copilot AI features for enterprises.

06 – 08 2026 Research Intern, **Handshake AI**, San Francisco, CA
Host: Curtis Northcutt
User simulation for benchmarking and evaluation of frontier AI.

01 – 05 2026 Student Researcher, **Google Research**, Mountain View, CA
Host: Kornraphop (Ken) Kawintiranon

Multi-agent debate for multimodal AI safety and alignment.

06 – 08 2025 Summer Fellow, **Centre for the Governance of AI**, London, United Kingdom
Collaborators: Risk Management Team (GovAI); Human Influence Team (UK AISI)
Chain-of-thought monitoring for harmful manipulation from advanced AI.

06 – 08 2024 Research Intern, **Asta Team, Allen Institute for AI**, Seattle, WA
Host: Joseph Chee Chang
Co-planning and co-execution with AI agents in scientific research [c.14].

06 – 09 2023 Research Intern, **Fairness, Accountability, Transparency, and Ethics (FATE) Group, Microsoft Research**, Montréal, Canada
Host: Q. Vera Liao
LLMs as UX design material [c.9].

01 2022 – Graduate Research Assistant, **Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering, University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Advisor: Amy X. Zhang
Human-centered tools and methods for AI safety + alignment [c.11–13, c.8, w.4, w.5]; social media feed curation via machine teaching [c.7, w.3].

09 2021 – Graduate Research Assistant, **Human Centered Design & Engineering, University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Advisor: David W. McDonald
Interactive machine learning for UX practitioners to design AI-powered applications [c.3, c.5, c.9].

08 2020 – 07 2021 Visiting Undergraduate Researcher, **University of Chicago AIRLab**, Remote
Host: Marshini Chetty
COVID-19 misinformation in private WhatsApp chats [c.2].

06 2020 – 06 2021 Undergraduate Researcher, **Center for Information Technology Policy**, Princeton, NJ
Advisor: Arvind Narayanan
AdOculos: a search platform and dataset for analyzing ads on the web, aided by computer vision [n.1].

Awards & Honours

2026 Best Paper Award, ACM CHI
Top 1% of submissions.
Industry Spotlight Award, ACM CAIS
1 of 10 out of 46 accepted demos.

2024 University of Washington nominee for Google PhD Fellowship
1 of 4 selected from UW Graduate School.

2023 OpenAI Democratic Inputs to AI grant
1 of 10 teams selected from 860+ worldwide.

2022 UW Herbold Fellowship
1 of 7 selected from UW College of Engineering.

2020 Princeton Council for Science and Technology Independent Project Award

2020 Princeton Office of Undergraduate Research Summer Research Award

2019 IDEO CoLab Fellowship Finalist

2018 Keller Center for Innovation in Engineering Education Summer Fellow

Invited Talks & Panels

2026 **Reflections on Human-AI Interaction**
Guest speaker, UW CSE510: Advanced Topics in Human Computer Interaction

Responsible AI via Human-Human, Human-AI, and AI-AI Collaboration
Google DeepMind

Designing for Human-AI Collaboration Across Levels of Autonomy
Apple AI/ML

Expert-Informed LLM Policies for High-Stakes Alignment
Snorkel AI
Handshake AI Research

Human-Agent Collaboration Across Levels of Autonomy
Google

2025 **Human-Agent Collaboration Across Levels of Autonomy**
Databricks

Human-Agent Collaboration: a Grand Challenge in the Agentic AI Era
UW CSE Industry Affiliates Showcase

Chain-of-Thought Monitoring for Harmful Manipulation from Advanced AI
UK AISI Societal Impacts Team

Designing for Interaction with Advanced AI
The Design Lab, UCSD

[Panel] AI Agents' Democratic and Economic Impacts
Artificial Intelligence and Democratic Freedoms, Knight First Amendment Institute

Cocoa: Co-Planning and Co-Execution with AI Agents
Guest lecture, UW INFO498: Understanding and Navigating Cognitive and Behavioral Change in the AI Era

2024 **Mapping the Design Space of Teachable Social Media Feed Experiences**
Princeton HCI

Canvil: Supporting Designerly Model Adaptation in LLM-Powered User Experiences
Guest lecture, UW HCDE598: Human-Centeredness in Generative AI

Case Repositories: Towards Case-Based Reasoning for AI Alignment
OpenAI Forum: Collective Alignment

2023 **Teachable Agents for End-User Empowerment in Personalized Feed Curation**
Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory (MINT) Lab, Australian National University

Canvil: Supporting Designerly Model Adaptation in LLM-Powered User Experiences
UW HCDE Academic Research Seminar
Microsoft Research Montréal
Microsoft Research FATE Group
Microsoft Research HCI Seminar

[Panel] Empirical look at user behavior
Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society, Knight First Amendment Institute

2022 **User Perceptions of Media in Provenance-Enabled Social Media Feeds**
Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity (C2PA) Technical Working Group

2021 **Lowering the Barrier for Web Advertisement Research at Scale**
Princeton Research Day
Princeton CITP Works in Progress Reading Group

2020 **User Interface Design, Prototyping, and Testing**
Princeton ACM

2019 **Introduction to User Interface Design**
HackPrinceton 2019

2018 **Introduction to User Interface Design**
HackPrinceton 2018

Service

2021 – **Program Committee:** FAccT 2024–2025
Reviewing: CHI 2023–2026*, NeurIPS Pluralistic Alignment Workshop 2024, CHI LBW 2024*, CSCW 2023–2026*, DIS 2023*, UIST 2022 + 2025–2026
* *recognition for outstanding review(s).*
Student Volunteer: CHI 2023, IUI 2022, UIST 2022
Departmental Service: HCDE PhD Visit Days session leader, HCDE PhD orientation student panelist, HCDE PhD application reviewer

2020 – 2021 **Organizer**, Princeton intersession course on ethical technology

2019 – 2021 **First-year engineering student advisor**, Princeton School of Engineering and Applied Science

2018 – 2021 **Founder**, Rehack (reverse hackathon for development of more socially responsible technologies)

Mentoring

2025–2026 **Tanjal Shukla**, UW CSE BS, lead author of [l.9].
Afterwards: Software Engineer at Amazon.

2023–2024 **Lawrence Tan**, UW CSE BS, co-authored [c.7].
Afterwards: Software Engineer at Stripe.

2022–2023 **Tony Li**, UW HCDE MS, co-authored [c.4].
Afterwards: PhD student at UCSD CSE.

2022–2023 **Maxwell Coppock**, UW HCDE BS, co-authored [c.5].
Afterwards: MS student at UW MHCI+D.

2022 **Amodini Khade**, UW HCDE MS.
Afterwards: Product Manager at NBCUniversal.
2022 **Katrina Vergara**, UW HCDE MS.
Afterwards: Product Manager at Microsoft.

Skills

Technical: Python, JavaScript, Java, Unity, C, OCaml, Go, SQL, LaTeX.
Other: Model policy design (authoring Model Spec/Constitutions), LLM evaluation and benchmarking, engineering AI agents, LLM fine-tuning, prompt engineering, human data campaigns, technical writing, laser cutting, art exhibition installation, bookbinding, photography.

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